SUMMARY

- The gastrointestinal tract is an active organ which digests and modifies the nutrients for absorption.
- Gastrointestinal diseases refer to diseases involving gastrointestinal tract that is esophagus, stomach, small intestine and large intestine and accessory organs of digestion.
- Diarrhoea is the condition when there is rapid transit of intestinal contents through the small intestine, reduced enzymatic digestion of foods and decreased absorption of nutrients. The therapy for diarrhoea consists of fluid and electrolyte management and dietary management.
- Constipation is defined as difficulty or infrequent passage of stools. There are three types of constipation. The primary nutrition therapy for constipation is including adequate amounts of dietary fibre, both soluble and insoluble and adequate amounts of fluids.
- Peptic ulcer is a term used to describe any localized erosion or necrosis of the mucosal lining that comes in contact with gastric juice. The key to the management of peptic ulcer is the judicious choice of drug therapy and dietary modifications.
- Hepatitis is an inflammation of liver. Hepatitis is classified as acute viral hepatitis and chronic hepatitis.
- Liver cirrhosis is a degenerative disease which is characterized by inflamed liver cells, abnormal fibrosis and development of nodules leading to obstruction and liver failure. One of the common symptoms of liver diseases is Jaundice.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Addison's disease	Addison's disease, also known as primary adrenal insufficiency and hypocortisolism, is a long-term endocrine disorder in which the adrenal glands do not produce enough steroid hormones.
Anal fissures	An anal fissure is a small, oval shaped tear in skin that lines the opening of the anus
Ascites	Accumulation of fluid in abdominal cavity
Atonic Constipation	Atonic constipation is the condition where bowel activity is reduced because of lack of normal muscle tone or strength in the colon
BCAA protein	Protein sources which are rich in branched chain amino acids (Leucine, Isoleucine and Valine)
Bland diet	A diet which contains mechanically, chemically and thermally non-irritating foods that are generally soft, well cooked, low in dietary fibre and not spicy.
Carcinoma	Carcinoma is the most common type of cancer. It begins in the epithelial tissue of the skin, or in the tissue that lines the internal organs, such as the liver or kidneys.

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